

```
file lnfile
lnfile: symbolic link to `sqr.c'

file /dev/sda
/dev/sda: block special

file /dev/tty1

/dev/tty1: character special

file /bin/grep

/bin/grep: ELF 32-bit LSB executable, Intel 80386, version 1
(SYSV), dynamically linked (uses shared libs), for GNU/Linux
2.6.24
BuildID[sha1]=c51ad343b8f16ec239e1a490d06fa9a276f0aecc,
stripped
```

Use the `-s` option with the `file` command to read the special files that are block or character special files. This is useful for determining the file system types of partitions that are block special files. Here are a few examples I worked out in my Linux system. Replace the file names in these examples with those in your system.

```
file -s /dev/sda
/dev/sda: x86 boot sector

file -s /dev/sda5

/dev/sda5: Linux rev 1.0 ext4 filesystem data, UUID=e15aa1d4-
8676-49c7-bea2-f001c7390f30 (needs journal recovery)
(extents) (huge files)

file -s /dev/psaux

(Now move the mouse)
/dev/psaux: ISO-8859 text, with no line terminators
```



Note: `/dev/sda` is the file name representing the first SATA hard disk and `/dev/sda5` is a partition on this hard disk.



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